



Differences between Tailwind and Bootstrap

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Tailwind stands out because of its strong integration with other software, rather than being just a standalone framework. It speeds up the development of websites and web applications by using Tailwind as the base CSS, where you only need to focus on customising it to match branding requirements.

Bootstrap, on the other hand, is very easy to use, but websites built with it are often recognisable due to its many predefined components. While Bootstrap is simple to work with, this simplicity can make customisation more challenging. It's particularly useful when functionality and utility are more important than the overall look and feel of the site.

Tailwind	Bootstrap
Provides pre-designed widgets with a utility-first approach	Focuses on components with a mobile-first approach, resulting in highly responsive site designs
Uses utility classes that allow for extensive customisation	Websites built with Bootstrap often look generic and similar to one another
A newer framework	A mature framework with extensive community support
Requires only a single base style file of around 30 KB	Needs at least four support files for full functionality, totalling around 310 KB
Has a steeper learning curve, especially for customisation	Easier to learn and use

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Cross-site scripting (XSS) and CDNs

CSS and JavaScript frameworks are often provided through CDNs (Content Delivery Networks) to improve site performance. However, using CDNs can introduce security risks if the CDN isn't trustworthy or becomes compromised. As you've learned, a CDN hosts files on behalf of the creators, but the servers may not belong to them directly.

The main security risk to be aware of is XSS (cross-site scripting) (GeeksforGeeks, 2024).^{fnref:b749f1} This is when cybercriminals inject malicious code into scripts on pages that users visit. So, whenever you use CSS or JavaScript code that isn't hosted on the same platform as your website or application, it's crucial to verify the authenticity of the source (CDN) to ensure it's safe.



Thoughts on this page?



Balancing performance and security

Should developers rely on CDNs for delivering CSS and JavaScript frameworks? Why or why not?

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Jorge Andres Guerrero Giraldo 14 Jan 2026, 12:54 PM

Developers can rely on CDNs for delivering CSS and JavaScript frameworks because they improve performance through caching and global distribution. However, they should also consider security risks such as dependency integrity and availability, and mitigate these by using Subresource Integrity (SRI) and having local fallbacks when necessary.

